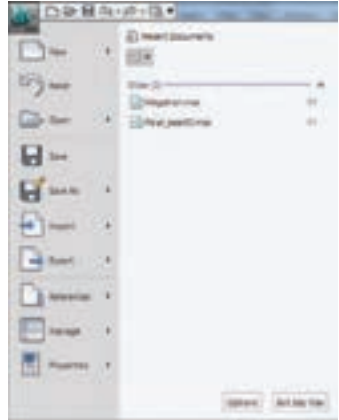


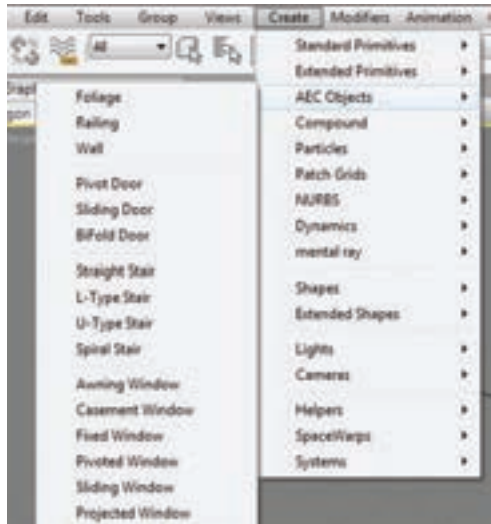
1.1.1 The Menu Bar

This is where you will find typical options you'll frequently access. It's located on the top of the window, similar to other Windows programs. Also since the 2010 edition, you will find an Application button which is the graphical representation of the different types of tools in the traditional File menu drop down. The Application button is also where you can set a project folder, access the Asset Tracking tool, and check statistics about the current file. In case you still want to use the traditional File menu, you can restore it to the 3ds Max interface from the Customize User Interface dialog box, under Customize.



The Application Button and Menu (Button at the top left corner of the screen)

Clicking a button in the menu bar issues a particular command and Max will take the required action. An option that's followed by three periods, called an ellipsis, opens a dialog box, which allows you to edit settings related to that particular option. An icon which has an arrow pointing to the right shows more options. This is called a cascading menu.



A Normal Cascading menu

1.1.2 The default Startup Layout

3ds Max can be very tricky at times. Because of the wealth of options available and if it changes its appearance getting work done can be a very tedious job figuring out what's where. Even between two different 3ds Max versions such as 2010 and 2010 design, there are major differences in the interface design. In 3ds Max 2010 you will see an interface, with the tools attune with the game and entertainment type of projects. If you find your 3ds Max User